FT FollowThrough

The Roofing Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- What's going on: a leak, storm damage, missing shingles or an old roof?
- Is water coming in right now? If so, offer to tarp or patch it first.
- How old is the roof, and has it been repaired before?
- Is there an insurance claim open for it?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what's going on with the roof and I'll see how we can help."

> "Can you text me a photo from the ground? I can come out Tuesday at 10 or Wednesday at 2. Which works better?"

2. Presenting the quote

- Go through it in person or by phone, not as a number in an email.
- Start with your photos from the roof: show them what you found before you talk price.
- Itemize tear-off, underlayment, shingles, flashing, cleanup and warranty, and price rotten decking per sheet.
- Offer two or three shingle options when it fits, and say how long the quote holds.

> "Here are the photos from your roof. Here's how I'd fix it, and here's the price. I can start the week of the [date]. What questions do you have?"

3. The 7 objections roofers hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "Your price is higher than the other guy's."
"That's fair, I'd compare too. What's included in the other quote? Materials, underlayment, warranty and cleanup are where prices differ. I'd rather you choose on what you get than on the number alone."

2. "I need to get a few more quotes."
"Totally reasonable. To make it easy, compare the shingle brand, underlayment, flashing, warranty and who does the work. I'll check back Thursday to answer any questions."

3. "Can you do it cheaper?"
"I can adjust the materials or scope to hit a budget. What number are you hoping for? Then I'll show you what that gets. I won't cut corners on the parts that keep your roof dry."

4. "My insurance should pay for it."
"If it's storm damage, I can document the roof with photos for your adjuster. I can't waive your deductible, because that's against the rules in many states, but I'll make sure the damage is well documented."

5. “I’ll wait until next year.”
“Understood. Small leaks can turn into rotted decking, which costs a lot more. Want me to patch the leak now so you have time to plan the replacement?”

6. “How do I know you’ll be around for the warranty?”
“Fair question. Here’s my license and insurance, and local references you can call. I put the warranty in writing so you’re covered either way.”

7. “Why do you need a deposit?”
“The deposit pays for your materials so they’re ordered on time. It’s all in the contract, and the balance is due once the work is finished and you’ve approved it.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the roof quote come through okay? Happy to go through the photos with you again.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], checking in on your roof. I have an opening the week of the [date] and can hold it for you until Friday.”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday so I can plan the schedule. If you’d still like to go ahead, or just fix the leak for now, reply and I’ll hold a spot.”

After strong wind or hail in their area, one more message is welcome: “Hi [Name], we had a big storm Tuesday. If you spot shingles in the yard, send me a photo and I’ll tell you if it’s urgent.”

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask right after the job, when they’re happiest, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with the roof, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a neighbor mentions their roof, I’d be glad to take a look.”

Neighbors notice a roof going on. With the owner’s okay, leave a yard sign up for a week, and introduce yourself on the street where door-to-door is allowed.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Never offer to waive or cover a deductible. It’s illegal in many states.
- Check your state and city rules on licensing, permits and door-to-door sales before you chase storm work.
- Put scope, price, payment schedule and warranty in writing, with a per-sheet price for hidden rotten decking.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for roofers: followthroughguides.com/roofing · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com